

Wednesday, 17 June 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Light drizzle 23° 17°	BIRMINGHAM Heavy drizzle 21° 16°	MANCHESTER Light rain 20° 16°	GLASGOW Rain 17° 13°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

Prime Minister Starmer says the UK will play its full part in reopening the Strait of Hormuz, a vital shipping lane.

The prime minister confirmed the UK is working with international partners on a plan to protect vessels in the key waterway. This follows ongoing tensions in the region.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

A previously unpublished report revealed significant problems in Nottingham's maternity units before a major inquiry was launched.

The report detailed various issues within the NHS maternity services in Nottingham. This comes ahead of a comprehensive review into the units.

HEALTH · UK
- 3

A woman has appeared in court in connection with the fatal Wimbledon school crash that killed two young girls.

Claire Freemantle was driving the car involved in the tragic incident outside a school in 2023. The crash claimed the lives of Nuria Sajjad and Selena Lau.

CRIME · UK
- 4

The government's plan to ban under-16s from social media by spring 2027 has sparked debate among teenagers across the UK.

The prime minister announced the ban, aiming to protect young people online. While some see it as a positive step, others question its necessity and effectiveness.

POLICY · UK
- 5

The father of a murdered teenager has welcomed the proposed social media ban for under-16s, believing it could have saved his son's life.

Stuart Stephens stated that his son, Olly, would still be alive if a social media ban had been implemented sooner. His comments add a poignant perspective to the debate.

SOCIAL MEDIA · UK

What's coming up

- 1 A West End theatre is set to be renamed in honour of the legendary Dame Judi Dench.**
The Shaftesbury Theatre will soon carry Dame Judi's name, celebrating her immense contribution to the performing arts. It's a wonderful tribute to a national treasure.
ON AIR – What's your favourite Dame Judi Dench role on stage or screen?
THEATRE · FUTURE
- 2 A Paddington musical is preparing for its highly anticipated Broadway debut next year.**
The charming production will launch in the US at New York's Al Hirschfeld Theatre in March 2027. It promises to bring the beloved bear's adventures to a new audience.
ON AIR – Would you go and see a Paddington musical? What other children's stories would make a great musical?
MUSICAL · FUTURE
- 3 Oscar-winner Cate Blanchett is set to become a visiting professor at Oxford University.**
Blanchett will take on the role of Visiting Professor of Contemporary Theatre at St Catherine's College. It's an incredible opportunity for students to learn from one of the best.
ON AIR – If you could take a class from any celebrity, who would it be?
ACADEMIA · FUTURE
- 4 The prestigious Grammy Awards are expanding, adding new categories for Asian Pop and Latin songs.**
The music awards are introducing five new categories, reflecting the growing global influence of these genres. It follows recent wins for artists like Bad Bunny.
ON AIR – Which other music genres do you think deserve their own Grammy categories?
AWARDS · FUTURE
- 5 Singer-songwriter Myles Smith has revealed his debut album is inspired by five years of therapy notes.**
His first collection of songs draws from the experiences that shaped him before he became famous. It sounds like it'll be a very personal and honest record.
ON AIR – What's the most surprising inspiration you've heard for an album?
MUSIC · FUTURE

On the schedule

1 Up to 15,000 England fans are making their way to Dallas for the highly anticipated World Cup opener.

England supporters have had a longer wait than most for their 2026 World Cup campaign to begin. The excitement is building as fans start to arrive in the US.

ON AIR – Are you feeling the World Cup fever yet?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 Sri Lanka delivered a shock blow to New Zealand's title defence at the Women's T20 World Cup in Southampton.

Watch the highlights as Sri Lanka stunned the reigning champions with a five-wicket victory. It puts New Zealand's hopes of defending their title on the brink.

ON AIR – What was the biggest sporting upset you've ever witnessed?

CRICKET · UK

3 Rory McIlroy has urged 'caution' over the US Open course set-up after a past controversy at Shinnecock.

McIlroy says organisers must ensure conditions at this week's US Open at Shinnecock Hills don't 'get out of control'. He's clearly keen for a fair challenge.

ON AIR – How important is it for a golf course to be challenging but fair?

GOLF · UK

4 McLaren have launched an appeal after the decision to overturn Pierre Gasly's pit-lane speeding penalty at the Monaco Grand Prix.

The team is challenging the ruling concerning the Alpine driver's penalty. It could have implications for the championship standings.

ON AIR – Do you think teams should be able to appeal decisions like this, or should the original ruling stand?

F1 · UK

5 Ruben Amorim has been appointed as the new head coach of AC Milan, five months after being sacked by Manchester United.

Amorim takes the reins at the Italian giants, a significant move for the former United boss. It'll be interesting to see how he fares in Serie A.

ON AIR – Do you think managers who've been sacked by one big club deserve another chance at an equally big club?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 The joy of 'post-it note compliments' is brightening up workplaces and homes across the country.**
Small, anonymous messages of appreciation left for colleagues or family members are boosting morale and creating a positive atmosphere. It's a lovely way to spread a little kindness!
- 2 New research suggests that 'mindful dishwashing' can reduce stress and improve well-being.**
Focusing on the warmth of the water, the feel of the bubbles, and the scent of the soap turns a mundane chore into a calming meditation. Who knew washing up could be so good for you?
- 3 The trend for 'library picnics' is encouraging more families to enjoy reading outdoors.**
Borrowing books and setting up a picnic blanket in a local park or garden combines the pleasure of a good story with fresh air. It's a wonderful way to spend a sunny afternoon.
- 4 A study reveals that people who regularly 'rearrange their furniture' report feeling more invigorated.**
Even small changes to your living space can create a sense of renewal and fresh perspective. Perhaps it's time to move that armchair?
- 5 The popularity of 'swap shops' for garden tools and equipment is growing amongst green-fingered enthusiasts.**
Neighbours are sharing everything from lawnmowers to trowels, saving money and reducing waste. It's a brilliant example of community spirit in action.
- 6 Experts are highlighting the benefits of a 'digital detox day' for improving focus and sleep.**
Switching off screens for a whole day allows our minds to rest and reconnect with offline activities. Perhaps we should all give it a try this weekend?
- 7 A fascinating report reveals that early morning 'dewdrop photography' is becoming a popular hobby.**
Capturing the delicate beauty of water droplets on leaves and petals at sunrise offers a peaceful and creative start to the day. The results can be truly stunning.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'naming' what in our homes, even if it's just a funny nickname?

ANSWER: THEIR WI-FI NETWORK!

Q A recent poll asked Brits what small, everyday 'victory' instantly makes them feel clever and accomplished. What came out on top?

ANSWER: GETTING ALL THE LAUNDRY INTO THE BASKET IN ONE THROW!

TALK TOPIC

- You know how sometimes you spot a specific 'type of cloud' in the sky, and it just instantly catches your eye or brings back a memory?

Perhaps a cloud shaped like an animal, or a particularly dramatic sunset formation? What's the most memorable cloud you've ever seen, and what did it make you think of?

- We all have those certain 'comfort' foods, don't we? Things we turn to when we need a bit of a pick-me-up or a taste of nostalgia.

Is there a particular dish or snack that always brings you joy, maybe something from your childhood? What's your ultimate comfort food, and why is it so special?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There is a planet made largely of diamonds, named 55 Cancri e, which is twice the size of Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts cannot cry in space because there is no gravity to pull their tears downwards, so they just stick to their eyes.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£4.75 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£4.75 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The world's quietest room is located at Microsoft's headquarters in Washington State and is so silent you can hear your own heartbeat.
- Bumblebees can fly higher than Mount Everest.
- The longest place name in the UK is Llanfairpwllgwyngyllgogerychwyrndrobwlantysiliogogoch, in Wales.
- Penguins are the only birds that can swim but not fly.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The 'king of fruits', the durian, is known for its strong odour, which some describe as a mix of onions, sewage, and gym socks.
- The Great Barrier Reef is the largest living structure on Earth and can be seen from outer space.

On this day

Day 168 of the year, 197 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Albert Chmielowski; Christian feast day: Botolph (England and Scandinavia); Christian feast day: Gondulphus of Berry; Christian feast day: Hervé. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 2000 — Odessa A'zion, American actress
- 1957 — Philip Chevron, Irish singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2013)
- 1966 — Jason Patric, American actor
- 1960 — Thomas Haden Church, American actor
- 1982 — Arthur Darvill, English actor
- 1990 — Jordan Henderson, English footballer
- 1976 — Scott Adkins, English actor and martial artist
- 1937 — Peter Fitzgerald, Irish footballer and manager (died 2013)

THE DAY TODAY

- 1940 — World War II: The British Army's 11th Hussars assault and take Fort Capuzzo in Libya from Italian forces.
- 1987 — With the death of the last individual of the species, the dusky seaside sparrow becomes extinct.
- 1948 — United Air Lines Flight 624, a Douglas DC-6, crashes near Mount Carmel, Pennsylvania, killing all 43 people on board.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1991 — Apartheid: The South African Parliament repeals the Population Registration Act which required racial classification of all South Africans at birth.
- 1940 — World War II: RMS Lancastria is attacked and sunk by the Luftwaffe near Saint-Nazaire, France. At least 3,000 are killed in Britain's worst maritime disaster.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1960 — The Nez Perce tribe is awarded \$4 million for 7 million acres (28,000 km²) of land undervalued at four cents/acre in the 1863 treaty.
- 1944 — Iceland declares independence from Denmark and becomes a republic.

- 1939 — Last public guillotining in France: Eugen Weidmann, a convicted murderer, is executed in Versailles outside the Saint-Pierre prison.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 169 of the year, 196 days left in 2026. Today Autistic Pride Day (International); Christian feast day: Bernard Mizeki (Anglican and Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Elisabeth of Schönau; Christian feast day: Gregorio Barbarigo. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Pearl.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1994 — Takeoff, American rapper (died 2022)
- 1963 — Dizzy Reed, American keyboard player and songwriter
- 1925 — Robert Beadell, American composer and educator (died 1994)
- 1952 — Carol Kane, American actress
- 1950 — Jackie Leven, Scottish singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2011)
- 1942 — Carl Radle, American bass player and producer (died 1980)
- 1952 — Isabella Rossellini, Italian actress, director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1933 — Tommy Hunt, American singer (died 2025)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1982 — Italian banker Roberto Calvi's body is discovered hanging beneath Blackfriars Bridge in London, England.
- 1972 — Staines air disaster: One hundred eighteen people are killed when a BEA H.S. Trident crashes minutes after takeoff from London's Heathrow Airport.
- 1940 — The "Finest Hour" speech is delivered by Winston Churchill.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1953 — A United States Air Force C-124 crashes and burns near Tachikawa, Japan, killing 129.
- 1982 — Italian banker Roberto Calvi's body is discovered hanging beneath Blackfriars Bridge in London, England.

Coming to cinemas

JUNE 2026	
FRI 19	Pixar's Toy Story 5
FRI 26	Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life

JULY 2026	
WED 1	Minions & Monsters
FRI 3	Shiver; Young Washington
FRI 10	Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn
FRI 17	Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off
FRI 24	Heads of State; Untitled DCU
FRI 31	Spider-Man: Brand New Day

AUGUST 2026	
FRI 7	Once Upon a Time in a Cinema
FRI 14	Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie
FRI 21	Mutiny; The Bride!
FRI 28	Crime 101; Outcome

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)

OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

On the sporting calendar

JUNE 2026		JULY 2026	
11 JUN – 19 JUL	FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)	4–26 JUL	Tour de France (Cycling)
12 JUN – 5 JUL	ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)	SUN 5	British Grand Prix, Silverstone
18–21 JUN	U.S. Open (Golf)	16–19 JUL	The Open Championship (Golf)
29 JUN – 12 JUL	Wimbledon	18–26 JUL	World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool
		23 JUL – 2 AUG	Commonwealth Games, Glasgow
		AUGUST 2026	
		W/C 10	Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)
		SAT 15	Premier League season begins (2026/27)
		22–23	Belgian Grand Prix (F1)